

Knowledge Transfer - Multi-Topic System Overview

Title: Core Platform Systems and Business Logic Participants: Emily (Leader), New Hires (Group of 10)

Duration: 90 minutes

(Transcript Start)

Emily: "Welcome to the Core Platform overview. I'm Emily, the Architect, and I designed the initial system. I'll cover two major components. First, the Data Ingestion Service. Historically, we used a batch processing system (circa 2018), which we replaced in 2021 with Kafka streams for real-time processing. This technical history is important because the legacy batch queues still run a few high-latency reports, but they should generally be avoided. The key pitfall here is assuming that all data is immediately available; some legacy reports still have a 2-hour delay. The primary business driver for this service is providing low-latency user activity metrics.

Second, the Subscription Management Service (SMS). This system is complex. It handles all billing logic and integrates with three external payment gateways. You must route all pricing change proposals through the Finance team (stakeholder: finance@team.com). A common troubleshooting tip for SMS is checking the audit logs—if a subscription seems stuck, nine times out of ten, it's a failure to receive a webhook from the payment gateway. We've had known issues where token renewal fails silently on specific legacy customer accounts—it's a known gap. The team ownership is clearly divided: Billing Team for the pricing logic, Infra Team for the Kafka clusters. I've uploaded the SMS Decision Log (which details why we chose Gateway X over Gateway Y) and the Kafka Cluster Health Dashboard link to the onboarding folder. I also sent you the full code links for both services, which are split into two repositories: `data-ingestion-stream` and `subscription-service-api`."

(Transcript End)